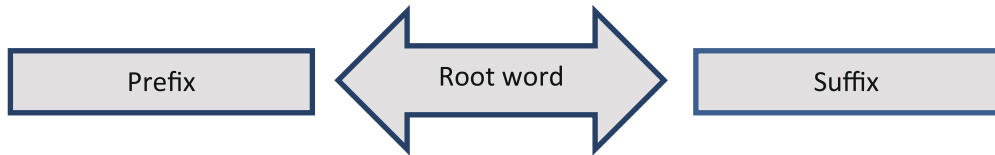


Lesson 1: An Introduction



un-comfort-able

(un = prefix; comfort = root word; able = suffix)

Now, separate the root words, affixes (prefixes and suffixes) of the following words and compare your answers with your partner:

unfair, empower, dishonest, misunderstand, helpful, player, coming, shortly.

A. Now, ask and answer the questions in pairs.

What is the common name of the groups of letters added to the root words to form new words?

What is known as a prefix?

What is a suffix?

Why do we use prefixes and the suffixes?

So, you can understand that an affix is a group of letters added to a word to change its meaning and parts of speech. Some affixes can be added to the front of words and some others at the back. An affix added to the beginning of a word to form a new word with new meaning is known as a prefix. For example, '*mis*' in *misunderstand*, and '*un*' in *untie* are called prefixes.

The most common prefixes in English are – *dis*, *in*, *re*, *un*. These four cover most of the prefixed words. On the other hand, the most common suffixes are – *ed*, *ing*, *ly*, *es*. They also cover most of the words made with suffixes.

B. Look at the following words that have added some letters at the end of the words (suffix). Try to separate the root words and the suffixes.

powerful, kindness, suddenly, latest, player

C. Now, read the most commonly-used prefixes, their meaning, and examples from the following table.

Prefix	Implied meaning	Examples
en	increase	enrich, encourage, enlarge, enjoy, endanger
un	not	unhappy, unjust, uncommon, unpaid, unready
re	again	rewrite, reenter, recall, return, rethink
in, im, ir	not	incorrect, impossible, irrelevant, irregular
dis	opposite	dislike, discomfort, dishonour, dismiss, disclose
non	not	nonsmoker, nonstop, nonregistered, non-Indian
im	not/opposite	impossible, impure, impatient, immoral
over	above /extra	overtime, overwork, overweight, overnight,
Il	opposite	illegal, illiterate, illegible, illogical, ill-practice
mis	wrong	misdeed, mistake, misguide, misunderstand
sub	under	substation, submarine, subcommittee, subdue
anti	against	anti-nuclear, anti-aircraft, anti-liberation

D. Look at some prefixes, their meaning, and words formed with them.

Prefixes	Implied meaning	Words formed
under	small/little	undersize, underpaid
co	with/together	co-author, coordinator

mal	opposite/bad	malpractice, malnutrition
de	opposite	defrost, deform
fore	front/before	forehead, forecast

E. Look at the most commonly-used suffixes, their meaning, and words made with them from the following table.

Suffixes	Implied meaning	Words/Examples
s, es	pluralize/make a verb singular	books, goes
ed	form past tense/ past participle/adjective	helped, (had) helped
ing	form present participle/ adjective/ gerund	running, running car
ly	Indicate <i>how</i> , ' <i>when</i> , <i>where</i> , <i>or</i> something happens	slowly, friendly
er	1. indicates a person who does a particular work 2. make comparative degree	player, farmer bigger, taller
ic	having qualities	heroic, patriotic
able, ible	able to be	comparable, invisible
ness	indicate state, condition, degree	brightness, kindness
ful	having something	powerful, handful
ment	completion	payment, punishment

Exercise 1

Make five new words using the following suffixes ing, ic,er, ful, es. Then compare your answer in pairs.

Exercise 2

Ask and answer the questions in pairs. Use affixes in your answers. You can choose the affixed words below. The first one is done for you.

invisible, recently, shortly, unkind, illegal

Question: Is Mr. Rahman kind to the poor people?

Answer: No, he is unkind.

When are you coming back?

Is the moon visible in the new moon?

Is it legal to drive a car when the red light is on?

When has your father come from abroad?

Exercise 3

Read the text and use affixes (prefixes and suffixes) to make the story grammatically correct. Then compare your answers with your partner.

Farzana began her journey when she receive an urgent call from her mother. Her journey was comfort because of bad weather. She was look for an umbrella as it was rain heavy. There was no rickshaw in the road. However, Farzana was astonish to see the kind of an auto driver. Hear her trouble, the drive offer her a lift. She was thank to the driver for his kind. "I will remember your help for long period of time", said Farzana. The driver polite made a bow, lowered his head towards Farzana and left the place.